

The Earth Serpent

This story is based on a creation myth from West Africa.

Mawu-Lisa, who was both He and She, stood on Aido-Hwedo's mighty tongue and raised a stick to the sky.

"Fly Aido-Hwedo, fly," called out Mawu-Lisa, the great God of All Creation.

Aido-Hwedo lifted his fine form skyward, taking great care not to crush the God standing inside his mouth. He carried his sacred cargo out into the universe, and for more time than anyone can count, they flew between stars and around planets.

"Land," commanded Mawu-Lisa finally, "this is where our work must begin."

The great serpent dragon swooped down to a giant rock. Mawu-Lisa guided him to slide across its surface, forming deep grooves into which water began to flow, becoming rivers.

